

“The focus at NSE is back on governance”

Ashishkumar Chauhan, MD & CEO of NSE, talks about the economy, markets, DPI, the role of exchanges, bringing more investors into the market, and more

PHOTO BY MANISH RAJPUT



India's capital markets are counted among the most well-regulated and stable ones globally. The National Stock Exchange (NSE) is right at the top globally in terms of the number of trades that take place on it. NSE MD & CEO Ashishkumar Chauhan, 55, wants to focus on the bigger role that bourses can play in the overall economic development of India. Chauhan, an IIT and IIM alumnus, has the unique distinction of heading both the leading bourses, BSE and NSE. In an interaction with *Business Today's* Sourav Majumdar and Ashish Rukhaiyar, Chauhan says that Indian exchanges are jointly working towards channelling more household savings into the financial assets space

even as they continue to make investors aware of the risks. Edited excerpts:

Q: The economy is facing a lot of headwinds due to a combination of geopolitical and macroeconomic concerns. What is your take?

A: There are wars happening and inflation is also rising. In some ways, India has done well when compared to most of the other economies. [The] Indian currency is also one of the better-performing currencies against the dollar. That clearly says that something has changed over the last eight to 10 years. India was once considered one of the ‘fragile five’ economies; now that kind of terminology is not used to describe us. Our services exports have helped us quite substantially and that is, in some ways, the future of India and the future of the world. The world is moving towards dematerialised services and dematerialised experiences and India is at the forefront. But in the short run, there can be lots of ups and downs. This government has been able to create buoyancy in taxation through automation of GST. It has built a lot of soft infrastructure which... is going to take India very far in terms of managing itself and also preparing its population for future wealth creation, growth, cohesion and integration, among other things.

Q: Do you think India's digital public infrastructure (DPI) has been a key game changer?

A: The soft infrastructure I referred to is DPI. And in some ways, NSE was the harbinger of DPI in India. DPIs have helped India become important internationally